

Professional Review Package

Assembled 2026-09-24T12:00:00Z

Important: This package organizes your own information; it is not a recommendation or valuation.

Provenance

Journey: employee_ownership

Journey version used: 0.2.0

Destination: dest-1

Destination version: destver-3 (number 3)

Business reality version: brver-2

Scenario versions included: scenver-esop-1

Scenarios excluded: MBO with two leaders (readiness: Preliminary)

Assembled: 2026-09-24T12:00:00Z

Executive Summary

What I want

Desired cash at closing: I'm not sure

Primary goal (journey): Securing the team's future

My must-haves

- Team security — All 40 employees kept for two years
- Keep all 40 employees for at least two years

Strong preferences

- Sale price — Above \$8M

Things I want to avoid

- A rushed sale at a discount
- Losing key people

Paths being evaluated

- ESOP 100% over 3 years

Main questions for my advisors

- Repurchase liability if profits fall

1. Owner Objective

Desired cash at closing: I'm not sure

Team security: All 40 employees kept for two years (must-have)

Sale price: Above \$8M (strong preference)

Location: Keep the Cleveland plant (preference)

Avoidance: reputation: No public layoffs after closing
Primary goal (journey): Securing the team's future

2. Priorities

Priority 1: Fair price

Priority 2: Community continuity

3. Nonnegotiables

Must-have (nonnegotiable): Team security — All 40 employees kept for two years

Must-have (nonnegotiable): Keep all 40 employees for at least two years

Strong preference: Sale price — Above \$8M

Preference: Location — Keep the Cleveland plant

4. Things the Owner Wants to Avoid

Journey: A rushed sale at a discount

Journey: Losing key people

Avoidance: reputation: No public layoffs after closing

5. Business Snapshot

Revenue: \$6.2M (audited figure) — owner reported, verification: Verified, period: FY2025

Employees: 40 — owner reported, verification: Unverified, period: current

6. Owner Transition Preferences

When would you like to step back?: Within two years

7. Scenarios Explored

Platform Scenario: These scenarios reflect the owner's stated objectives and the assumptions currently recorded in the platform. They are exploratory and are not a professional determination.

ESOP 100% over 3 years

- Type: ESOP · lifecycle: modelable · readiness: ready for professional review
- Seller-financed ESOP with a staged buyout.
- Open questions this scenario does not yet answer:
 - Repurchase liability if profits fall (importance: critical, status: open)
- Recorded conflicts (see Trade-Offs):
 - Full liquidity conflicts with staged seller financing (severity: material)

Not included: MBO with two leaders (readiness: Preliminary) — below the ready-for-professional-review readiness required for package inclusion.

8. Assumptions Used

Scenario: ESOP 100% over 3 years

valuation: Sale price — \$8.5M (provenance: OwnerReported, verification: Unverified)

financing: Bank debt share — 60% of price (provenance: ScenarioAssumed, verification: PartiallyVerified). Owner carries a seller note.

9. Trade-Offs Identified

ESOP 100% over 3 years: Full liquidity conflicts with staged seller financing (severity: material)

10. Questions for Professionals

Question 1 (platform-derived)

- Please help resolve: Repurchase liability if profits fall (importance: critical, scenario: ESOP 100% over 3 years)

Question 2 (platform-derived)

- Please validate: Sale price — currently \$8.5M and unverified (scenario: ESOP 100% over 3 years)

These questions were generated from the owner's recorded gaps and unverified assumptions. They are not advice, and the platform does not know what the answers should be.

11. Selected Professional Team

Nothing recorded yet — the journey has not recorded professional team selections yet.

12. Professional Determinations

Scenario included for review: ESOP 100% over 3 years — not yet reviewed by a professional.

No professional has reviewed this package yet. v1 has no professional review engine; any future determination will be attributed to the professional who made it, never presented as a platform recommendation.

13. Current Working Plan

Destination version: dest-1 (version 3)

Journey version used: employee_ownership v0.2.0 — walk completed

Business reality version: brver-2

Preferred timing: Within two years

Scenarios in the plan: ESOP 100% over 3 years